Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Volume 58 Number 12 Circulation: 1,650 December 2014 Sunnyvale, California Editor: Phyllis Fowler

There is no Monthly Meeting because of the Holidays

The LVNA Parade scheduled for December 6th

Holiday Lighting Contest December 20th

Check out our NEW website: www.lvna.net
Facebook Group page: Lakewood Village LVNA
And Our NEW Facebook page: Lakewood Village LVNA





President's Message

By Fred Fowler

It's Parade Time!

Greetings Neighbors!

The days are chilly again, the leaves are turning colors and the noonday sun stands low in the sky. We all know what that means. It's Parade Time in Lakewood Village!

Come one, come all on Saturday, December 6th to watch the latest edition of the **Lakewood Village Holiday Parade** wind its way through our neighborhood streets. The **Lakewood Elementary School Color** Guard will lead it off at 11:00am from the corner of Lakechime and Meadowlake in front of Lakewood School. They will be followed by the combined forces of the **Fremont High School and Columbia Middle School marching Bands**, a big bunch of awesome classic cars, a fire engine, police cars, and of course the big man himself, Santa Claus. There will be lots of marchers of all kinds, from celebrities to school kids, all proudly strutting their stuff for the community. At the end of the parade (in the Fairwood Park picnic area) there will be the usual reception where everyone can enjoy some hot cocoa and cookies and the fellowship of living in the best neighborhood in Sunnyvale. You won't want to miss it! ◆

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Holiday Lighting Contest

By Fred Fowler

Greetings neighbors. It is December again, and it's time for the **LVNA Lighting Contest!** Part of our holiday tradition is to recognize the hard work, creativity and inspiration of Lakewood residents who decorate their houses at this time of year. Some of those houses are a sight to behold! As I've said before, no neighborhood in Sunnyvale lights up the way we do, and people come from as far away as Morgan Hill and San Francisco to enjoy the lights and marvel at the spectacle. It is another tradition that makes Lakewood Village a special place to live.

(Continued on page 4)



Rides for Toys

When: Saturday, December 6, 2014
Time: 10 A.M. - 1 P.M.
Where: Toys 'R' Us Parking Lot
130 East El Camino Real

The Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety is hosting its annual "Rides for Toys" . During this free special charity event, each child who donates a new, unwrapped toy will be given a ride on a Sunnyvale fire engine.

Parents will have a chance to discuss fire safety with Sunnyvale Public Safety personnel and receive informational brochures.

Sunnyvale firefighters will present the donated toys to Sunnyvale Community Services, a nonprofit organization supporting those in need in our community.

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Both of these articles are reprinted from the Lion's Roar, Lakewood School's Newsletter

Extreme Makeover at Lakewood!

By: Jordan Coney and Tommy Mai

The big construction project at Lakewood is coming Along well, and hasn't run into any big problems yet.

The construction is being run by Mr. Rob Smiley and Mrs. Pam Cheng, our Lakewood School Principal. Mr. Smiley has worked on many other school projects before Lakewood School. Construction began near the playground and close to the Library last June, right after the students left for summer vacation. The cafeteria and school entrance are also being rebuilt. The main part of the construction this fall is building new classrooms for the third, fourth and fifth graders.

The construction project was started because the school needed lots of improvements. As Mr. Smiley said, "We talked to the teachers about what they wanted in the new rooms. We had to look at how much money we had." The entire project will cost about $15,000,000. As our principal Mrs. Cheng said, "It was approved for $15,000,000, but it was originally less than that."

Construction is expected to finish next summer vacation, after the last new buildings have been built. Lakewood students and teachers are looking forward to the new buildings. As Kylee Valenica, a fourth grader, says, "The old classrooms were dirty and old, the new classrooms have new carpet and walls." ◆

Lakewood Plugs into Technology

By: Naomi Nishikawa, Justin Ramirez and Arthma Ranasinghe

Lots of exciting things are happening with technology at Lakewood school! "Things are always rapidly changing and that's the way technology is," said Al Bacalso, the IT specialist at Lakewood School.

Staff, students, and teachers are using technology to improve children's education. "Teachers are constantly asking what apps do we have, what technology can we have, what can we use, and what websites can we use for education," said Ms. Perry, third grade teacher, who is on the technology team.

Technology is in the classrooms, in the computer lab, and in the office. It is used differently in different classrooms. "Ipads are mostly used in kindergarten, 1st grade, and 2nd grade. Chromebooks are mostly for the 3rd, 4th,and 5th grade," Ms. Perry added.

Technology can be used at UA time, Daily 3, or any time there is individual work. The internet is used on Ipads and also chromebooks. "Technology allows kids and students to open more educational content," said Mr. Bacalso. Technology helps students learn Math, Reading, and History. "Technology helps you make google docs, and create movies," said Ms.Tsai, 2nd grade teacher. The school is buying new apps, Ipads, and chromebooks, and improving the internet. "There is always going to be new technology and new apps, software," said Mr. Bacalso. ◆



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Columbia Neighborhood Center

Near Columbia Middle School at 739 Morse Ave.

Drop-in Fitness Room



When: Every Monday & Thursday
Time: 6:30 – 8 pm
When: Every Tuesday
Time: 7:30 – 9 pm
When: Saturdays from
Time: 8 – 9:30 am and 10:30 am to noon
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: $1.00 per participant—cash only

The program is staffed by an attendant who is First Aid and CPR certified. Participants must prove they live in Sunnyvale. Middle School students can participate if accompanied by a parent/guardian. High School students can participate if a parent/guardian signs the waiver/consent form. Forms must be completed before participation. Participants should wear athletic shoes, and bring water and a towel. ◆

Free Legal Clinics

When: First Saturday of the month
Time: 10 am – Noon
Where: Columbia Neighborhood
Cost: Free!

Columbia Neighborhood Center and South Asian Bar Association of Northern California partner to provide free legal clinics. Get a 20 – 30 minute legal consultations on any legal matter, provided by a licensed attorney. ◆

Youth Drop-In Gym

Basketball: Fridays 7 – 10 pm

Indoor Soccer: Mondays 7 – 9 pm
Saturday 7—10 pm
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: 50¢ per visit for residents
($1 for non-residents).



Must be Middle or High School student. **School ID REQUIRED for entry!**

Drop-In Gym will be cancelled if there are no participants in the first hour. ◆

No Classes 12/23/14—1/4/15

Zumba Classes

When: Wednesdays at 7-8 pm
Fridays from 6-7pm
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Cost: $1.00 per person per visit



Adults and children over 10 years of age. (with an adult/guardian) are invited to participate. There will be **no childcare**, and children will not be allowed to wait in the gym or lobby because of child endangerment issues parents should not leave their children without adult supervision inside or outside the Center. ◆



Bilingual Story Time

When: Thursday
Time: 4 – 5 pm
Where: Columbia School Library

Fun and games with one of Sunnyvale's bilingual librarians.◆

Library Lending Machine

In the CNC lobby, with books for small children through middle school. You only need a Sunnyvale Library card to use it, and CNC staff can provide you with one. Bring identification and proof of residency. Any SV Library

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Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all ages
11:00 a.m. Worship Service

Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting





Bus: 408-541-1368
Cell: 408-242-6467

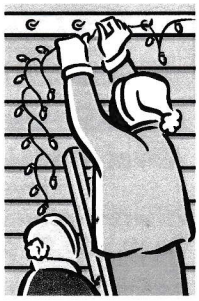
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Holiday Lighting Contest



By Fred Fowler
(Continued from page 1)

The rules are simple. Get your creative juices flowing and show us all what you can do! Decorations can be hand-made or store bought. They can be small and modest or huge and spectacular. It doesn't matter. All that is important is that they are expressive and sincere. They need to convey the spirit of the neighborhood and of this special time of year. Many people in Lakewood Village have taken up this challenge in past years and produced memorable results. I expect this year's entries to be even better than before.

The neighborhood is divided into four pieces, separated east-west by Lawrence Expressway and north-south by Lakehaven/Sandia avenue. A winner will be chosen for each section. There is also a "grand champion" selected for the entire neighborhood as a whole.

The results will be listed on LVNA.net and are published in the January newsletter.

We haven't identified the "celebrity judge" as of yet, but the date of the judging has been set. To be eligible to participate, your decorations must be powered on and available for review on the evening of Sunday, December 20th. Judging will take place on that night only, rain or shine. If you want to take part in the competition, be sure to be ready!

To those of you who are about to start decorating, I would like to say "thank you very much!" Your efforts help give Lakewood Village both a "personality" and a "soul" that is not very common among communities in Silicon Valley. All of our lives are richer because of the community we live in, and our community is nothing more than a bunch of ordinary people who occasionally get together to do things for the benefit of all.

A philosopher once said "it is better to light one small candle than to curse the darkness". We go one better. We light up a whole neighborhood! Thanks for doing so, and may the most creative decorations win! ◆

Family Harvest Program



Free monthly food distribution for families with a child under 18 living at home, and meeting certain income guidelines: maximum household gross monthly income $2,622 (2 people); $3,298 (3 people); $3,975 (4 people).

For more information or to complete an application, bring photo ID, proof of monthly income and proof of all children living in the home to Columbia Neighborhood Center. ◆

It's the Season for Trash!

Holiday Tree Recycling



The ***City of Sunnyvale*** and ***Specialty Solid Waste & Recycling*** offer holiday tree recycling from *December 29, 2014 to January 16, 2015.*

Specialty Waste makes as easy as 1-2-3!

1. Remove all decorations, light strands and tree stand
2. Cut tree into 4 foot or shorter lengths
3. Single-family residents may place tree at curb on collection day, or inside yard trimmings cart if the lid can close.

That's all there is to it!

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New Holiday Exhibit - now OPEN!

When: Tuesday/Thursday/Sunday until January
Time: 12-4pm
Where: Sunnyvale Historical Museum
570 E Remington Drive

Our new Holiday Exhibit is finally ready for viewing at the Sunnyvale Historical Museum. This collection of **"Department 56" Dickens Village collectables** are now decorating our temporary exhibit room.

Visit the museum and get a jump start on the spirit of the holiday season.

The exhibit is open to the public during normal museum hours from noon to 4pm] and will be on display until the beginning of January.
Phone: (408) 749-0220 ◆

ESSEX presents... Sunnyvale Holiday Tree Lighting

When: December 6. 2014
Time: 5pm - 7:30pm
Where: Downtown Sunnyvale - Murphy Avenue

Come on down to Downtown Sunnyvale for the annual Holiday Tree lighting. The festivities will include a visit for Santa Claus, activities for and loads of holiday cheer. There will be fun for the entire family.

Annual entertainment includes but not limited to:

Dance Attack!

Spirit of Sunnyvale Marching Band

Columbia Middle School

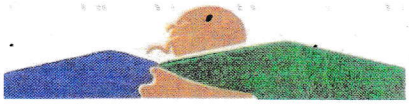
Fremont High School

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Santa Claus! ◆



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Top Holiday Safety Tips

Inspect electrical decorations for damage before use
Cracked or damaged sockets, loose or bare wires, and loose connections may cause a serious chock or start a fire.

Do not overload electrical outlets
Overloaded electrical outlets and faulty wires are a common cause of holiday fires. Avoid overloading outlets and plug only one high-wattage appliance into each outlet at a time.

Never connect more than three strings of incandescent lights
More than three strands may not only blow a fuse, but can also cause a fire.

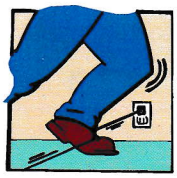




Keep free fresh by watering daily
Dry trees are a serious fire hazard.

Use battery-operated candles
Candles start almost half of home decoration fires (NFPA)

Keep combustibles at least three feet from heat sources
A heat source that was too close to the decoration was a factor in half of home fires that began with decorations. (NFPA)



Protect cords from damage
To avoid shock or fire hazards, cords should never be pinched by furniture, forced into small spaces such as doors or windows, placed under rungs, located near heat sources, or attached by nails or staples.

Check decorations for certification label
Decorations not bearing a label from an independent testing laboratory such as Underwrites Laboratories (UL), Canadian Standards Association (CSA) or Intertek (ETL) have not been tested for safety and could be hazardous.



Stay in kitchen when something is cooking
Unattended cooking equipment is the leading cause of home cooking fires (NFPA)

Turn off, unplug, and extinguish all decorations when going to sleep or leaving the house
Unattended candles are the cause of one in five home candle fires. Half of home fire deaths occur between the house of 11:00pm and 7:00am (NFPA)



Have a safe and happy Holiday! ◆

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Public Safety - Emergency	911
Public Safety - Non-emergency	730-7100
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal	Dispatch 730-7180
Noise complaints—Desk Officer	730-7110
Neighborhood Preservation Complaints on decrepit fences, , weeds, illegal home businesses or rentals	730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
Public Works- sidewalks, trees, streetlights, etc.	730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline & Shopping Cart Pickup	730-7680

Street Sweeping:

Fairwood Side - 12/ 02 & 12/16& 12/ 30
Lakewood Side - 12/09 & 12/23 & 1/ 06

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To submit articles or letters for publication, please contact the editor before the 28th of each month
Send your document or inquiry to Phyllis Fowler: sunnyphyl@gmail.com

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